Tim Everard

Operations Manager

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PROFILE

Operations leader with 15 years' experience managing teams, freelance staff and budgets across live events, broadcast and tournament operations, most recently heading a six-person department at BLAST. Day to day that has meant staff rotas, hiring and training, invoice approval, supplier management and being the main point of contact for partners and teams on operational matters. Restructured a department for clearer ownership and accountability, and built the tools the team uses for tracking, scheduling and budgets. Across six years at BLAST that included 2,000+ freelancers managed, 60+ flagship events and €12m+ in budgets. Experienced working across multiple sites and productions, with a practical, hands-on approach to keeping people and operations running smoothly day to day.

2,000+	60+	€12m+	300+	13
freelancers	flagship esports events	in budgets	qualifiers	countries

EXPERIENCE

Head of Esports Operations — Jun 2023 – Oct 2026
BLAST

- Led a six-person department running tournament operations across every BLAST ecosystem, including CS2, Dota 2, Brawl Stars, Fortnite, Rocket League and Rainbow Six
- Rebuilt how the department works, with clearer ownership, accountability and proper documentation
- Brought Team Operations into the department, so all online and offline player management and support sat with one team
- Designed and built the department's own tools for tournament operations, event and equipment tracking, freelancer calendars, bookings and contracting, and event budgets and deadlines
- Costed and pitched new tournament work with the product and commercial teams
- Wrote the business case for a departmental OPEX budget covering equipment renewal, software and cross-event costs
- Set technical requirements for commercial partnerships

KEY SKILLS

Operations leadership
Team leadership, people management, restructuring, process improvement

Staffing and rotas
Hiring, training, rotas, supervising staff across multiple sites and productions

Commercial and finance
Budgets, invoice approval, business cases, stakeholder management

Freelancers and vendors
Freelancer booking, contracting and payments, vendor management

Event management
Tournament and player operations, event logistics, site visits, bootcamps

Systems and tooling
Microsoft Office, Google Workspace, Airtable

Safeguarding and safety
Designated Safeguarding Lead, first aider, fire marshal

CERTIFICATIONS

First Aid at Work	2022
Safeguarding Lead (DSL)	2021
Working at Heights	2018
Moving Head Maintenance	2018
Manual Handling	2018
Fire Marshal	2018
PAT Testing	2016
IPAF	2012

References available on request.

Tournament Operations Manager

Jan 2020 – Jun 2023

BLAST · Contractor to Mar 2021, then permanent

- Main tournament-level contact for FACEIT, ESIC and BLAST Premier teams
- Booked and managed tournament operations freelancers for internal, external and online productions
- Managed tournament equipment and staffing budgets across CS:GO, Dota 2, Apex Legends, FIFA, Fortnite and Rainbow Six
- Approved equipment and staffing invoices, and decided when to hire, buy or repair tournament kit
- Arranged venues and equipment for team bootcamps
- Designated Safeguarding Lead and first aider at live events

Broadcast Freelancer

Jan 2018 – Jan 2020

Self-employed · Alongside Jam Television

- Crewed broadcasts and live events for clients including BLAST Pro Series, ESL UK and ESL Germany, BBC, Sky Sports, ITV, Immediate Media, NATS, Big Ben (WRC), Altitude Angels and Create Broadcasting
- Worked in the gallery as technical director, producer and graphics operator on live shows
- On-stage admin at esports events, and consulted on production and technical setups for clients

Broadcast and Studio Manager

Mar 2018 – Jan 2019

Jam Television · Birmingham

- Hired freelancers and ran staff rotas to keep a 24-hour TV channel on air, including holiday cover and emergency call-outs
- Trained staff on studio equipment and workflows
- Managed suppliers, invoice approval and day-to-day maintenance, including software and hardware updates
- Designed a multi-camera TV studio from scratch, bought the equipment, and managed installation and testing
- Controlled the studio budget, including equipment purchasing

Production Manager

Jul 2015 – Dec 2017

ESL UK · Leicester

- Hired freelance crew, managed rotas and supervised internal and external staff on live shows
- Trained crew on equipment and workflows, and ran equipment hire, installation, testing and maintenance
- Managed production for both studios and at external events including MCM, EGX and Formula E
- Controlled production budgets and purchased studio and event equipment
- Built and set up the technical infrastructure for two ESL UK studios
- Worked in the gallery as technical director, producer and graphics operator on live broadcasts

Senior Lighting and Event Technician

Jun 2012 – Jun 2015

Dorking Halls · Casual Technician Mar 2010 – Jan 2011

- Controlled the equipment and training budget, and ran in-house lighting training
- Covered whatever the show needed, working as audio engineer, stage hand or stage manager
- Maintained specialist kit for a theatre and two cinemas, from lighting and audio desks to 35mm and digital projectors
- Carried out PAT testing on the venue's electrical equipment
- Set up and ran touring and in-house performances
- Head of lighting for The Darkness's support act, support lighting engineer for Enter Shikari, head of audio and lighting for Lee Mack, and comedy tours with Jimmy Carr, Dara Ó Briain and Ed Byrne